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Hikers Unite for 25th Annual “Seek the Peak” Event to Support Mount Washington Observatory

Nearly XXX has been raised this year in support of Mount Washington Observatory’s “Seek the Peak” Quarter Century Mark

North Conway, NH –This July, hikers and outdoor enthusiasts will gather in support of Mount Washington Observatory’s (MWOBS) annual “Seek the Peak” Hike-a-Thon. Now celebrating 25 years of impact, the fundraising event invites family, friends and adventurers to raise funds to support MWOBS operations, forecasting, research and educational programs. Hikers of all abilities can register at seekthepeak.org and start fundraising, with the $50 sign-up fee counting toward their fundraising total. This week, MWOBS will be matching donations up to $20,000, In July, they will be matching donations up to $25,000.

While Mount Washington is one of the most popular hikes each year, participants may choose any trail, any day leading up to July 19th. MWOBS welcomes climbers of all ages and abilities to choose a trail that matches their pace and hiking style, which can range from a competitive summit to a leisurely nature walk. MWOBS is partnering with Forest Service to advise hikers to make smart decisions on the trail to keep trails and nature clean and unharmed. Hikers in New

Hampshire and across the country join together to fundraise in support of Mount Washington Observatory's programs and services. Registration fees are waved for all students and kids under the age of 15.

MWOBS welcomes everyone to join their largest fundraiser at Après Hike Expo on Saturday July 19th, from 4:00 to 7:00pm at Great Glen Trails. This family-friendly event includes live music, giveaways, a BBQ-style feast provided by Chef Joes Catering, Tuckerman Brewing Company's beer garden, a rock-climbing wall, and several prizes and gear raffles. This year, MWOBS is partnering with Granite Outdoor Alliance in support of their mission to protect and preserve nature and help to bring NH-gear brands to the expo. All participants have the opportunity to tour MWOBS' mountaintop weather station and enjoy summit cookies provided by Big Dave's Bagels during the Seek the Peak weekend. Interactive weather-themed games will be included for kids to learn and play at the event as well.

"This event is more than just a hike; it is a celebration where the community comes together to support the observatory and the beauty of the White Mountains. All our accomplishments and successes are possible due to the generosity of our supporters," said Drew Bush, MWOBS Executive Director. "We strive to keep millions of visitors to New Hampshire outdoors and inspire them through educational programs, which is all achievable because of the support of nearly 328 enthusiastic participants"

Last year, nearly 400 participating hikers raised more than $228,000 to support MWOBS operations, research, weather services and educational programs. To continue generating crucial funding for its programs and services, MWOBS is aiming to raise $250,000 during the 25th anniversary event. So far, more than XX participants have joined in this year's efforts, raising nearly $107,100.

Hikers can sign up with a group or individually at seekthepeak.org, with the option to select "Hike and Make Friends" to find fellow participants who match their hiking abilities and preferences. Fundraising participants will receive 2025 Seek the Peak t-shirts, backpacks, patches, entry to gear raffles, and can enjoy the food, music and games at the expo.

Seek the Peak is made possible by Presenting Sponsors Arc'Teryx, Eastern Mountain Sports, Helly Hansen, Martini Northern and Great Glen Trails, with additional support from Event Sponsors, Tuckerman Brewing Company, Minus33, Oboz Footwear, Garmin, Mountainsmith, NEMO Equipment, L.L.Bean, The Soaking Pot, Vail Resorts, Wildly Responsible, White Mountain Oil & Propane, Burgeon Outdoor, Granite Outdoor Alliance, the Appalachian Mountain Club, Fairfield Inn by Marriott, Northeast Delta Dental, NHPR, Good To-Go, Mount Washington Radio Group (93.5 WMWV, Magic 104.5, and Easy 95.3), Peter Limmer & Sons, Mt. Washington Auto Road, Mount Washington Cog Railway and New Hampshire State Parks.

To learn more and to register, visit: seekthepeak.org. MWOBS reminds hikers to hikeSafe and Leave No Trace.

PHOTOS/PHOTO CAPTIONS

About Mount Washington Observatory: Mount Washington Observatory is a private, nonprofit, member-supported institution with a mission to advance understanding of the natural systems that create Earth's weather and climate. It serves this mission by maintaining a weather station on the summit of Mount Washington, performing weather and climate research, conducting innovative science education programs, and interpreting the heritage of the Mount Washington

region. Our summit facility is located within Mount Washington State Park. For more information, call 603-356-2137 or visit mountwashington.org.

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